

RRB NTPC Graduate Level Special Practice Series

Top 10 High-Yield General Awareness Questions (NRA & CBT-2 Master Mock)

Question 1: Delhi Sultanate Specialized Administration

Source: RRB NTPC Graduate Level (CBT-2) Exam, 2022 | **Topic:** Market Bureaucracy under the Khiljis

During the reign of Alauddin Khilji, a highly centralized and strict market control mechanism was implemented to stabilize commodity prices. Which of the following officials was specifically appointed as the Supreme Superintendent of the Grain Market (Mandi) to maintain direct regulatory control over merchants and prices?

- A) Diwan-i-Mustakharaj
- B) Barid-i-Mandi
- C) Shahna-i-Mandi
- D) Sarai-i-Adl

Correct Answer: C) Shahna-i-Mandi

Strategic Explanation: RRB Graduate Level papers heavily feature Alauddin Khilji's administrative machinery. The Shahna-i-Mandi was the chief market superintendent who maintained a ledger of all registered merchants. Diwan-i-Mustakharaj was the department created to recover revenue arrears, Barid-i-Mandi was an intelligence officer/spy who reported market conditions to the Sultan, and Sarai-i-Adl was the specialized open market for cloth and luxury goods.

Question 2: Vijayanagara Empire Macro-Provincial Systems

Source: RRB NTPC Graduate Level (CBT-2) Exam, 2017 | **Topic:** The Nayankara Land Tenure Framework

In the provincial administrative hierarchy of the Vijayanagara Empire, the central crown exercised military control over far-flung territories through powerful military chiefs called Nayakas. The specific land tracts or revenue-yielding territories assigned to these chiefs in lieu of cash salaries were known as:

- A) Manyams
- B) Iqta
- C) Amaram
- D) Khalisa

Correct Answer: C) Amaram

Strategic Explanation: This question serves as an excellent operational filter in graduate papers. Under the Nayankara System, the King granted Amaram (land tenures) to the Nayakas. In return, these chiefs maintained a mandatory military contingent for the King and sent annual revenue remittances. Manyams were the local tax-free lands assigned to village-level Ayagars, Iqta was the land assignment system of the

northern Delhi Sultanate, and Khalisa was land directly managed by the royal crown.

Question 3: Bahmani Successor States: Art & Infrastructure

Source: RRB NTPC Graduate Level (CBT-2) Exam, 2017 | **Topic:** The Splintering of the Bahmani Kingdom

The architectural marvel Gol Gumbaz, which houses the tomb of Mohammed Adil Shah and features the second-largest whispering dome in the world, is located in Vijayapura (Bijapur). The Adil Shahi dynasty that constructed it originally splintered from which independent medieval kingdom?

- A) The Kakatiya Dynasty
- B) The Bahmani Kingdom
- C) The Yadava Kingdom
- D) The Delhi Sultanate

Correct Answer: B) The Bahmani Kingdom

Strategic Explanation: Graduate-level papers frequently test the five successor sultanates that formed after the internal collapse of the Bahmani Kingdom post-1482. The Adil Shahi dynasty of Bijapur was founded by Yusuf Adil Shah as a breakaway faction from the Bahmanis. This question links architectural landmarks directly with political fragmentation.

Question 4: Early Medieval Period: Democratic Local Governance

Source: RRB NTPC Graduate Level (CBT-2) Exam, 2022 | **Topic:** The Chola Assembly Mechanics

The Imperial Cholas of the early medieval period are universally celebrated for their highly advanced and democratic local self-government system. The exact eligibility criteria, qualification terms, and election rules for selecting members to the village committees (Sabha) are explicitly detailed in which historic inscription?

- A) Aihole Inscription
- B) Allahabad Pillar Inscription
- C) Uttaramerur Inscription
- D) Junagarh Rock Inscription

Correct Answer: C) Uttaramerur Inscription

Strategic Explanation: The Uttaramerur Inscription (issued during the reign of Parantaka Chola I in Tamil Nadu) is a perennial favorite for RRB Graduate Level exams. It serves as a historical record of how early Indian rural democracies operated, detailing how village councils were divided into wards and members were elected via a lottery system (Kudavolai). Aihole refers to Chalukyan history (Pulakeshin II), and Allahabad Pillar covers Gupta history (Samudragupta).

Question 5: Delhi Sultanate Fiscal Policy (The 'Double Agriculture' Trap)

Source: SSC CGL Tier-2 (Mains) Exam | Topic: Financial Jurisprudence and Revenue Classification

Sultan Firoz Shah Tughlaq is historically celebrated for regularizing the Sultanate's economy by abolishing nearly 24 irregular cesses (Abwabs) and retaining only the four canonical taxes prescribed by Islamic law. When he constructed an extensive network of state canals to boost agrarian yield, he levied a specialized 10% irrigation tax on farmers utilizing state water resources. What was the exact nomenclature of this irrigation tax?

- A) Kharaj
- B) Ushr
- C) Sharb / Haqq-i-Sharb
- D) Khams

Correct Answer: C) Sharb / Haqq-i-Sharb

Strategic Explanation: All four choices are canonical or state-sanctioned agricultural collections, making the options incredibly close. Most candidates choose Kharaj or Ushr because they are standard land revenue taxes. However, Sharb (or Haqq-i-Sharb) was the highly specific irrigation tax introduced by Firoz Shah Tughlaq after consulting religious scholars. Khams represented the state's 1/5th share of plundered war booty.

Question 6: Vijayanagara Architecture (The 'Erecting Dynasty' Trap)

Source: SSC CPO SI (Sub-Inspector) Exam | Topic: Dynastic Architectural Patronage at Hampi

The spectacular Vitthala Temple Complex at Hampi, universally acclaimed for its iconic Stone Chariot and 56 musical monolithic pillars, represents the absolute zenith of the Vijayanagara style of architecture. Which specific dynasty of the Vijayanagara Empire originally commenced the construction of this legendary temple structure?

- A) Sangama Dynasty
- B) Saluva Dynasty
- C) Tuluva Dynasty
- D) Aravidu Dynasty

Correct Answer: A) Sangama Dynasty

Strategic Explanation: This is a classic chronological trap. An overwhelming majority of candidates select the Tuluva Dynasty because they know the temple's most famous expansions were added during the golden reign of Emperor Krishnadevaraya (Tuluva line). However, historical consensus confirms that the foundational core of the Vitthala Temple was commissioned under King Devaraya II, who belonged to the Sangama Dynasty. Krishnadevaraya only added the grand pavilions (Mandapas) later.

Question 7: Bahmani Splinter Successors (The 'Overlapping City' Trap)

Source: SSC CHSL Tier-1 Exam | Topic: Territorial Demarcation of Deccan Sultanates

Following the political collapse and internal fragmentation of the centralized Bahmani Kingdom, five independent Deccan Sultanates emerged. The strategic Nizam Shahi Dynasty, famously led in its later years by the heroic regent Malik Ambar and Queen Chand Bibi, established its principal capital at which of the following cities?

- A) Bijapur
- B) Golconda
- C) Ahmadnagar
- D) Bidar

Correct Answer: C) Ahmadnagar

Strategic Explanation: This question tests exact geopolitical matching. The options are confusing because all four cities were capitals of various splinter sultanates. The Nizam Shahis ruled from Ahmadnagar (founded by Malik Ahmad Nizam Shah). Bijapur was the seat of the Adil Shahis, Golconda was the stronghold of the Qutb Shahis, and Bidar was the final capital of the core Bahmanis.

Question 8: Indus Valley Civilization (Archaeological Discoveries)

Source: RRB NTPC Stage 1 (CBT 1) Official Paper | Topic: Indus Valley Civilization (Archaeological Sites & Discoveries)

During the excavation of various proto-historic settlements of the Indus Valley Civilization, distinct structural and civic components were discovered. At which of the following Harappan sites was the famous terracotta model of a plough (terracotta hal) discovered?

- A) Lothal
- B) Kalibangan
- C) Banawali
- D) Mohenjo-daro

Correct Answer: C) Banawali

Strategic Explanation: While evidence of actual ploughed fields was discovered elsewhere, the specific terracotta toy/model of a plough was excavated at Banawali, located in the Hisar district of Haryana. This discovery provided direct material proof that the Harappans used ploughs for agricultural cultivation. Lothal is famous for the earliest artificial brick dockyard, Kalibangan is famous for actual furrowed fields, and Mohenjo-daro for the Great Bath and Dancing Girl.

Question 9: The Vedic Period Institutional Developments

Source: SSC CPO SI (Sub-Inspector) Exam | Topic: Later Vedic Political Assemblies and Institutional Shifts

During the Early Vedic (Rigvedic) period, tribal assemblies exercised significant democratic check over the chief (Rajan). However, by the Later Vedic period, territorial kingdoms emerged, causing a sharp decline in the status of popular assemblies. Which democratic Vedic assembly, which originally allowed

the active political participation of women, completely disappeared or barred women from attending during the Later Vedic phase?

- A) Sabha
- B) Samiti
- C) Vidatha
- D) Gana

Correct Answer: C) Vidatha

Strategic Explanation: This question sets up a deceptive institutional trap between the major Vedic assemblies. Most candidates narrow down their choices to Sabha or Samiti because these are heavily discussed in basic textbooks and they recall women losing rights to attend Sabha. However, the assembly that was primarily a folk gathering for religious, military, and distributive purposes, and which completely disintegrated and vanished as an institution in the Later Vedic period, was the Vidatha. The Sabha and Samiti survived but changed their character to favor elite nobles.

Question 10: The Sangam Age Eco-Zone Classification

Source: SSC CHSL Tier-1 Exam | Topic: Classification of Landscape and Eco-zones (Tinais)

Sangam literature is celebrated for its deep integration of romantic poetry with geographical landscapes, classifying the Tamil territory into five distinct ecological zones known as Tinais. Which of the following Tinais specifically represented the arid/desert wasteland landscape, where the presiding deity was the fierce goddess Korravai?

- A) Kurinji
- B) Mullai
- C) Palai
- D) Marutham

Correct Answer: C) Palai

Strategic Explanation: This tests precise terminology of early South Indian geography. Kurinji represents the hilly/mountainous tracks (deity Murugan). Mullai represents pastoral/forest lands (deity Mayon). Marutham represents fertile agricultural plains (deity Vandan). The correct answer is Palai, which represents the dry, parched, arid wasteland or desert landscape.

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